

3ds max

3ds max is one of the most sophisticated 3D software that makes your images come alive. Here, we take you through nifty tips that take your work to a new animated dimension



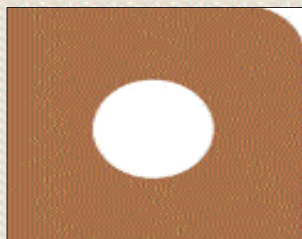
3ds max is one of the most popular 3D applications used in the broadcast and film industry. Its intuitive toolsets help you create professional-quality 3D models, photo-realistic still images, and film-quality animation on your PC.

The new channel, Pogo, has made excellent use of animation to package itself. We will use the Pogo logo as an example to help understand the plethora of features that are hidden in 3dsmax.

Creating the element

The basic element of Pogo is a square with its top-right corner rounded.

Let's create this shape: Click on the Front viewport to activate the viewport.



The basic form of the Pogo logo

Click the Create tab in the command panel. Click the Shapes button to display the Splines shape type.

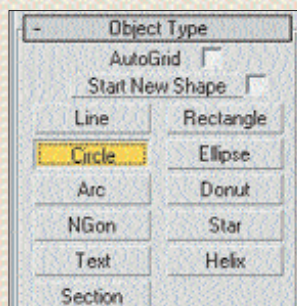
On the Object Type rollout, click rectangle. Click the Keyboard Entry rollout to open it. Here, select a numeric field with the mouse and enter a value of 50 in the Length and Width field. Leave the Corner Radius value at 0 and click Create.

Observe the Front view-

port. You now have a square of 50 units. Name this element as Pogo_element in the Name and Color field.

Create embedded shapes

We need to embed a circle inside the square, so that we can modify the size of the circle in animation. While there are many techniques to do so, 3ds max offers you a simple method to create this effect.



Select circle to get that shape in the animation

To embed a new shape, select the 'Pogo_element' that you have created in the Front viewport. Go to the Create panel and uncheck the 'Select New Shape' option in the rollout. Now, click the Circle button. Open the Keyboard Entry rollout. Enter 10 as the Radius value and click Create.

The new shape is a part of



View the shape from the Front viewport

the 'Pogo_element'. Move the shape in the Top Viewport, using the Select and Move tool, and both move together.

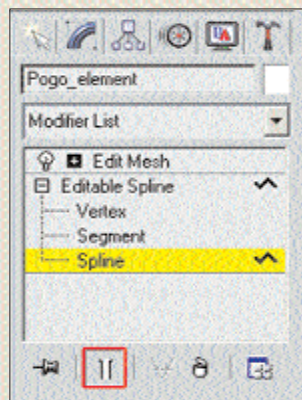
Dynamic mouse undo

If you are moving the 'Pogo_element' from the existing position to a new position by left-clicking and dragging the mouse, you can cancel this action by keeping the left-click pressed and clicking the right button once. This is a handy tool to check certain functions without committing your actions.

Animating the hole

First, convert the object into a mesh. Select the object, click on the modifier list and select Edit Mesh. Alternatively, press [E] after clicking on the modifier list to jump to the Edit Mesh modifier.

Expand the Editable Spline modifier controls and select the spline module. Click on the circle in the object and the selected spline is displayed in red. Click on the 'Show end result on/off' toggle button



The magic icon to preview the end result